

SNIPER RIFLES

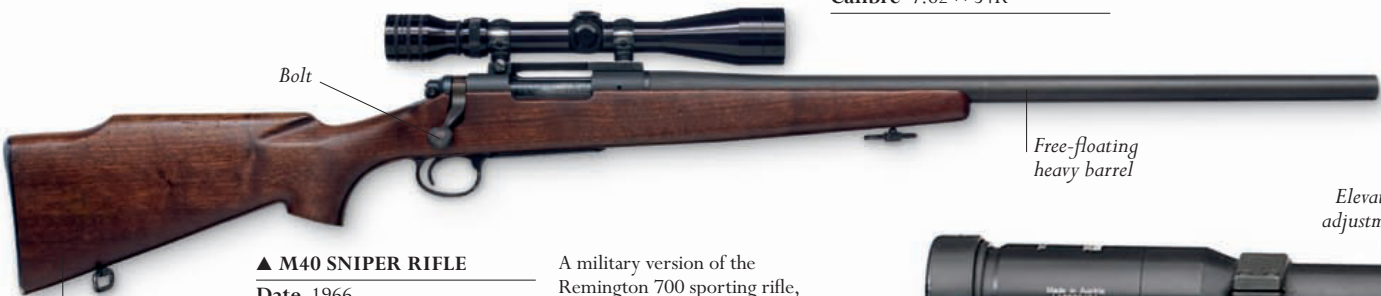
Military sniper rifles traditionally derived from two sources: first, the improved military rifle, fitted with a telescopic sight and firing match-grade ammunition; and secondly, the hunting rifle, which although highly accurate was often insufficiently robust for field conditions. During the late 1960s, small-arms designers finally began to produce rifles specifically designed for sniping. The M40 and the SS69 led the way, and were followed by a succession of superbly accurate firearms, such as the L96A1. Recent developments include the introduction of the 50-calibre heavy sniper rifle, and the .300 Winchester and .338 Lapua Magnum rounds, which are increasingly replacing the standard 7.62mm NATO cartridge.



▲ **DRAGUNOV SVD**
Date 1963
Origin Soviet Union
Weight 4.3kg (9½lb)
Barrel 61cm (24in)
Calibre 7.62 × 54R

The SVD came to be used as a sharpshooter platoon-support weapon by Warsaw Pact armies in the 1960s. Its four-power PSO-1 telescopic sight has limited infrared capability.

Ten-round detachable box magazine



▲ **M40 SNIPER RIFLE**
Date 1966
Origin US
Weight 3.1kg (6¾lb)
Barrel 61cm (24in)
Calibre 7.62 × 51mm

A military version of the Remington 700 sporting rifle, the M40 was first used by the US Marine Corps in Vietnam. Subsequent models were equipped with a fibreglass stock and a Unertl ten-power scope.

Wooden stock

Free-floating heavy barrel

Elevation adjustment



▼ **STEYR SSG69**
Date 1969
Origin Austria
Weight 3.9kg (8½lb)
Barrel 65cm (25½in)
Calibre 7.62 × 51mm

Developed for the Austrian army, the SSG also proved popular with police organizations. The SSG69 was unusual in its use of a five-round rotating spool magazine housed within the rifle body.

Five-round removable box magazine

Bolt handle

Ten-power telescopic sight



Six-power Kahles ZF69 telescopic sight

Port for spool magazine

Synthetic stock